

Enter writer/layout artist Joe Simon and artist Jack Kirby.

Said Simon, "And comics you had to build your business. If you had a character that was not successful, and you had to go home and figure out another character that would be successful. Otherwise, you're out of work. So we were always trying to come up with something new. Otherwise, we would just sit in our little hotels or roommate houses and wait for a call that never came."

Simon and Kirby took their youthful enthusiasm and began brainstorming a new idea. Said Simon, "At the beginning, Batman was doing very well. Basically, on the use of his villains. The Joker, you know...and then Superman had Lex Luthor...But so I said, 'Maybe...that's the answer. You know, get yourself a good villain.'" And in those days, there was no better villain than the real-life leader of the Nazi party, Adolf Hitler. So Simon and Kirby's true challenge became a matter of finding Hitler's perfect opposite. An opposite they discovered in a new hero named Captain America.

Captain America Comics #1 debuted in March 1941. While other heroes had worn red, white and blue outfits, Goodman, Simon and Kirby permitted no doubt in their political leanings. Captain America wasn't just battling Nazis on the cover of his first issue. He was punching Hitler himself right in the face.

Fulfilling the wishes of many would-be soldiers, Simon and Kirby told the tale of weakling Steve Rogers, whose frail body prevented him from helping the war effort despite his earnest intentions. But with the aid of a top-secret Super-Solider serum, Rogers soon became a perfect